

Misinformation related to birth control pertains to incorrect or misleading information surrounding birth control and its medical, legal and societal implications. This misinformation is mostly related to contraceptive methods that do not contain basis in science. Belief in this misinformation can deter people from using effective solutions in favor of solutions that are entirely ineffective and, in some cases, harmful to health.

Reasons for birth control myths

Some reasons that individuals may believe in birth control myths include:

Naturalness bias. As a form of automatic (unconscious) cognitive bias, people may psychologically view products or methods that are branded as more "natural" as always also being "linked to purity and safety". This is not necessarily a correct type of assumption, for various reasons. For example, entirely natural substances such as bacteria or cyanide can be deadly.

Exaggerated or false news media reports, combined with a lack of access to effective educational programs.

Uncertain, fearful, or anxious thought processes and emotions. For some individuals, these may be encouraged by some online testimonials that contain excessive fearmongering about hormonal birth control. These may include posts on social media platforms like TikTok, that spread birth control myths. A 2025 study found that most such videos are inaccurate, many consisted of anecdotes, and 90 percent of the video creators lacked a medical background. Viewers might not be shown more accurate advice, due to a social media algorithm. The intimate presentation of a social media video may feel relatively authentic, though social media influencers "often make money from posts 'sponsored' by various companies". By comparison, licensed medical doctors are liable under legal statutes (such as the Anti-Kickback Statute). Though doctors attempt to provide patient autonomy and informed consent, there

may also be a feeling of medical autonomy with social media videos. However, creators without medical credentials may suggest less effective birth control methods that are more likely to fail and cause an unintended pregnancy.

Insufficient contraceptive counseling. Some individuals may not have had their concerns initially addressed by medical providers, or may not have had access to adequate information.

Common myths

Purported adverse side effects

Menstrual cycles/maternity

Sexual practices

Substances erroneously believed to be contraceptive

Misconceptions and myths around how birth control works

== References ==